EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

LOW CODE APPLICATION • LABORATORY REPORT

Experiment aim

To examine how AI-assisted capabilities and analytics can support interpretation of application data and improve operational decisions.

Application / case context

The Gym Enrollment app stores membership plans, preferred activities, start dates, and contact details. Analytics could help staff understand plan demand and enrollment trends. The supplied screenshots do not show Zia being used, so this report distinguishes potential capabilities from verified features available in the current account.

Report structure: background, design, procedure, verification, results, conclusion and references. Any feature not confirmed by supplied evidence is identified as a proposed design or procedure.

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1. Aim, Objectives and AI Concepts

AI-assisted features can help users interpret data, generate summaries, discover patterns, or create analytics through natural-language prompts, depending on the product edition and feature availability. Built-in analytics can include reports, charts, and dashboard elements even when advanced AI is unavailable.

Objectives: distinguish ordinary charts from AI-assisted analysis; identify suitable questions for the gym dataset; consider data quality and privacy; and define a safe evaluation process for AI-generated results.

Example questions: Which membership plan is most frequently selected? How many enrollment requests have a start date in the next month? Which activities are most commonly selected? These can often be answered with standard reports and charts; AI may make exploration easier but is not required for basic counting.

AI-assisted analytics should be treated as an exploratory interface to data, not an independent source of truth. The result depends on the dataset, the selected filters, the wording of the question, and the feature's interpretation of the available fields. A well-written response can still contain a wrong count or use the wrong date range.

Evaluation requires a known answer. Manually count the records for a small question, ask the available AI feature to answer the same question, and compare the values. Record the prompt and filters used. If the result differs, inspect whether the model interpreted a label incorrectly, ignored a filter, or used a different aggregation.

Privacy must be considered before using AI features. For this lab, aggregate membership counts or synthetic records are sufficient. Names, phone numbers, home addresses, and health notes should not be included in prompts unless the product configuration and applicable policy explicitly permit the processing.

Small datasets support demonstration, not strong predictions. Report the number of records and the date range, and distinguish correlation from cause. If an AI feature is unavailable in the current plan, a normal report can demonstrate the underlying analytical question without falsely claiming that Zia was used.

The scope of this experiment is deliberately limited to a lab-scale application. It demonstrates the underlying concept and the verification method; it does not establish production readiness without the additional checks described in this report.

Objectives and scope

This experiment studies the difference between standard reporting and AI-assisted analysis, with a focus on answer verification, feature availability, and privacy.

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2. Potential Use Cases for the Gym Application

Descriptive analytics summarizes what has happened, such as enrollment count by plan. Diagnostic analysis explores why a pattern might exist, though small datasets rarely support reliable causal conclusions. Predictive analytics estimates future outcomes and requires sufficient historical data and careful evaluation.

Potential Zia-assisted tasks, if enabled: ask questions about report data, generate or configure charts, summarize a dataset, or assist with formula/script development. Availability and exact names depend on Creator plan, region, and product updates.

Do not send unnecessary health notes, personal addresses, or phone numbers into AI prompts. Use aggregate or anonymized data for experiments and verify every generated result against the underlying records.

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Analytics should state the time period and sample size. For example, a chart showing the current five test records is not evidence of long-term demand. If the dataset contains duplicate test submissions, remove or label them before drawing conclusions about plan popularity.

AI-generated summaries should be checked for unsupported assumptions. A high count for one plan does not necessarily mean members prefer it generally; the result may reflect the test data, a limited date range, or the way the sample was collected.

AI evaluation should include ambiguity checks. Ask a question with an exact date range, then ask a similar question with a different range and verify that the totals change accordingly. If the tool does not expose filters or explain which records were included, treat its answer as provisional.

Standard reports remain valuable because they are inspectable and repeatable. For a lab report, it is acceptable to state that advanced AI was unavailable in the trial and then demonstrate the same business question through a chart or grouped report. That is a real finding, not a failed experiment.

Design / configuration summary

Question	Simple verification
Plan popularity	Group records by Membership Plan and count rows
Upcoming starts	Filter Preferred Start Date to a future period
Activity interests	Count activity selections if report supports aggregation
AI output check	Compare answer with manually filtered records

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3. Exploration Procedure

Open the application and identify any Zia, AI, analytics, or chart-assistance options visible in the current account. Record the exact feature name and availability; do not assume every account has every capability.

Choose a non-sensitive question such as enrollment count by membership plan. Run the query or create a standard report/chart if AI functionality is unavailable. Record the input, output, date, and any filters used.

Validate the result by comparing it with a manually filtered report or independently counted sample. If the AI result cannot explain its source or filters, do not use it for operational decisions.

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Procedure and configuration checklist

- Identify the exact AI/analytics features available in the account.
- Choose a question with a manually known answer.
- Run the AI feature or a standard report if unavailable.
- Compare results and document limitations.

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4. Evaluation, Limitations and Responsible Use

AI output can be incorrect, incomplete, or misleading when data is sparse, fields are inconsistent, or prompts are ambiguous. A chart generated from two records cannot support broad claims about customer preferences.

Evaluate accuracy, reproducibility, usefulness, and privacy. Keep test data non-sensitive, review access settings, and do not treat AI-generated fitness or medical interpretation as professional advice.

If the feature is not available in the current trial, document the limitation and demonstrate the same analytical question with a report or chart. This is more honest than claiming an AI feature was tested when it was not.

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Verification checklist

- Record prompt, filters, sample size and output.
- Compare AI result with a manual count.
- Avoid sensitive data in the experiment.

5. Results and Conclusion

The gym dataset offers simple analytical questions that can be answered through reports and charts. AI assistance may reduce setup effort where available, but it does not replace validation or data governance.

The screenshots supplied for the app do not show a Zia interaction. Therefore, this report presents the exploration method and use cases rather than asserting that Zia features were executed.

Conclusion: AI is most useful when it makes a well-defined task easier and its output can be checked. For small operational datasets, standard reports may be sufficient; AI features should be evaluated on accuracy, availability, and privacy.

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A good conclusion separates observed results from expected results. Report any failed test and the next corrective action plainly; a documented limitation is more useful than claiming a pass that the evidence does not support.

Learning outcomes

- Distinguished ordinary reports from AI assistance.
- Designed an evaluation with a known answer.
- Recognized dataset and privacy limitations.

Conclusion

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References

Zoho Creator product overview: https://www.zoho.com/creator/

Zoho Creator Help: https://www.zoho.com/creator/help/

Zoho AI/Zia information: https://www.zoho.com/zia/

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6. Designing an AI Evaluation

An AI evaluation should begin with a fixed set of questions and a known answer. For example, manually count records by Membership Plan, then ask the available assistant or analytics feature to produce the same breakdown. Compare the numbers, not just the wording.

Record the exact prompt, applied filters, data period, result, and any mismatch. If the platform feature cannot cite the records it used, treat the result as exploratory and confirm it in a normal report before acting on it.

Use aggregate data for the lab. Do not submit names, phone numbers, home addresses, or medical notes to an AI feature unless the feature, account configuration, and applicable policy explicitly permit that processing.

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Practical application to the lab

The Gym Enrollment app stores membership plans, preferred activities, start dates, and contact details. Analytics could help staff understand plan demand and enrollment trends. The supplied screenshots do not show Zia being used, so this report distinguishes potential capabilities from verified features available in the current account.

Evaluation criteria

A satisfactory lab result should be reproducible, supported by a clear configuration or test record, and honest about limitations. Record the setup, test input, expected result, actual result, and evidence. If a feature was not enabled or tested in the current account, report that as a limitation and describe the procedure needed to complete it.

Checklist for submission

- Confirm the report matches the experiment title and stated objectives.
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- Separate verified outcomes from proposed implementation steps.
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7. AI Experiment Log and Final Recommendations

Use a small anonymized sample with known values. Store the exact question, expected answer, observed answer, and verification result. Repeat the same prompt after changing filters to see whether the output follows the intended scope.

Do not infer causes from a simple chart. A plan may appear popular because the sample is tiny or because test records are unevenly distributed. Report sample size and limitations with every conclusion.

Final recommendation: use AI as an aid to exploration, not as an unchecked source of truth. If Zia is unavailable in the current account, document that limitation and demonstrate the question using a standard report.

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